

it may be fear of conflict. This is especially true of husbands. They are more likely to deceive their spouses if they are suffering marital problems, including financial ones. In the process of trying to hide all traces of the true situation, they may borrow additional money to keep up the front, including tapping every close friend or relative.

Unfortunately, this ruse cannot be maintained forever, and eventually the truth will be known. It may be the creditors or a series of snide comments by friends or family, but eventually the facts will surface.

When a wife has been deceived and learns the truth from a source other than her husband, the results are predictable. First, she is hurt and offended that seemingly everybody knew the truth but her. Then, she is distrustful because she wonders what else is being kept from her. In her eyes, her position in the family has been downgraded because her husband has no confidence in her. Soon, many other areas of their relationship will be questioned and an air of distrust will be generated.

GET AWAY FROM IT ALL

Just as many people under the pressures of financial problems buy new cars and boats to lift their spirits, many families seek to escape their present symptoms.

When finances really get tight, one of the common tendencies is to take a vacation. The logic is simple: retreat into something that will be remembered as a happy experience. On vacation, troubles are temporarily left behind. Unfortunately, those who try to avoid facing reality in this manner quickly discover that a vacation under stress is no different than a job under stress. By the time the trip is over, the symptoms are even worse.

The ultimate escape for many families is to quit their jobs and move to another area for a "fresh start." Just as in the previous circumstance, this will not help. This "get-away-from-it-all" urge needs to be controlled and the situation faced squarely and honestly.